Market research

Using Data to Drive Business Performance

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How the market research was done

What we reviewed	NCES degree statistics, IPEDS completions through Data USA, published curriculum studies, and AACSB accreditation data. Syllabus, textbook and employer studies appear in their own sections below.
How	We retained published figures with their source years, separated degree counts from course and program evidence, and combined two of them into illustrative reach proxies. Each proxy is shown with its assumptions and would need publisher validation.
What we looked for	The scale of the student audience, where relevant courses are required, and which course settings are plausible adoption opportunities.

Finding 1: a large, required course

375,418 degrees, 2021-22	**Business bachelor's degrees awarded in the U.S.** About one in five of all bachelor's degrees.Source: NCES [1]
85% of 61 business schools	**Require at least one information systems course in the business core** 52 of 61 schools studied (89% of them AACSB-accredited); 3% required two IS courses.Source: Fustos, Morris and Haga [2]
12,092 awards in 2024	**Management information systems degrees awarded** Up 3.4% over the prior year. Counts all award levels reported, not only bachelor's degrees.Source: Data USA [3]
87.3% of 394 IS programs	**Offer a data and information management course** 344 of 394 U.S. undergraduate IS programs in business schools (data collected in 2013).Source: Hwang, Ma and Wang [4]
285 of 535 AACSB schools	**U.S. AACSB-accredited schools that offer an information systems program** A further 109 offer an undergraduate business analytics program (Table 2).Source: Zheng et al. [5]

82% of 74 IS master's programs	**Require a data, information and content management course** 61 of 74 programs at AACSB schools: a graduate audience for the same material.Source: Yang [6]
81,835 awards in 2024	**Accounting degrees awarded, an adjacent audience** Accounting information systems courses cover much of the same ground. All award levels reported.Source: Data USA [7]
1,098 institutions	**AACSB-accredited institutions worldwide** In 71 countries and territories, as of September 2026.Source: AACSB [8]

Award levels: the Data USA counts (MIS and accounting) are IPEDS completions across all award levels reported, not bachelor's degrees alone. The NCES figure counts bachelor's degrees only.

Two routes, one book

A commonality we found: **most business schools in the published studies require an information systems course of every business student, and most IS programs offer a database course.** The proposed routes address these two settings; fit must be reviewed against each course's outcomes and available teaching time. In round numbers:

About 320,000 Illustrative reach proxy	**Business students who reach a required IS course** 375,418 business bachelor's degrees (2021-22) × the 85% of business schools that require at least one IS course (2017 study).Source: Our estimate from [1], [2]
About 10,600 Illustrative reach proxy	**MIS students in programs with a database course** 12,092 MIS degrees across all award levels (2024) × the 87.3% of IS programs that offer the course (2015 study).Source: Our estimate from [3], [4]

Planning assumptions: each proxy multiplies a degree count by a historical, program-level share from a different source year. They are not enrollment-weighted course-seat estimates, and the MIS count covers all award levels. The two audiences overlap and must not be added together. Publisher enrollment and adoption data are needed to estimate addressable annual seats.

Adoption fit

Adoption fit is described qualitatively: which courses could use the courseware, what they need, and what a review should confirm. No revenue, seat or institution forecasts are made.

Segment	Likely need	Validation focus	Adoption opportunity
Primary Applied business database / MIS data management	Relational thinking, SQL, design, implementation, and business interpretation in one coherent learning path.	Course outcomes, annual sections and student seats, required database engine, incumbent materials, and switching criteria.	Full courseware adoption with readings, guided practice, independent labs, assessment, and instructor resources.

Segment	Likely need	Validation focus	Adoption opportunity
Business core data / IS course	Data meaning, information systems, queries, reporting, and a bounded project.	Which chapters fit the existing course and how much SQL and design it expects.	The business-core route through the same chapters.
Accounting information systems	Data meaning, controls, reporting and integrity.	Which modules fit the existing course.	Modular adoption or a companion pathway, subject to course fit.
Business analytics foundations	Data preparation, trustworthy SQL measures, and reporting.	Required design depth, analytical prerequisites, and reporting platform.	A selected chapter and lab route that supplies the database foundation for analytics.

Main conclusion The evidence supports exploring two defined course routes: the applied business database / MIS course, which this book leads with, and the required business-core data / IS course. Their outcomes, tools and switching criteria should be validated separately.

References

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